PRE-SEED · $1M · 2026

The Crypto Lending Platform That *Explains Itself.*

Crypto-collateralized lending infrastructure for credit unions — with AI-powered underwriting guidance built in. Pre-Seed · $1M · 2026

140M	$2.2T	$0
CU MEMBERS IN THE US	CU ASSETS UNDER MANAGEMENT	B2B CRYPTO LENDING INFRASTRUCTURE

SCROLL

01 · PROBLEM

Credit unions are *locked out* of crypto lending.

140 million Americans trust their credit union over any bank. But when those members want to unlock liquidity from their Bitcoin or Ethereum holdings, they're forced to go to D2C lenders like Nexo or Ledn — or sell, triggering a taxable event.

Credit unions want to serve these members. The regulatory complexity is the barrier — not the appetite.

01 No compliant crypto lending infrastructure exists for NCUA-regulated institutions

02 D2C competitors (Nexo, Ledn, SALT) aren't B2B — they compete with CUs, not serve them

03 Younger members with crypto assets are migrating to fintech — CUs are losing them

04 No risk assessment model purpose-built for crypto collateral under NCUA guidelines exists

05 Custody, bank connectivity, and KYC/AML integration requires months of compliance work per institution

02 · SOLUTION

The *full stack* a credit union needs to go live.

Every competitor is building faster pipes. Aetherum builds the explanation layer — the first crypto lending platform that tells a member why they can borrow what they can borrow, automatically, at the point of decision.

01 · Lending Engine

Crypto-Collateralized Loans

Members keep their BTC/ETH exposure, avoid the taxable sale, and receive USD liquidity at 8–12% APR. Real-time LTV monitoring with automated margin calls.

02 · Risk

DACS™ Risk Assessment

Dynamic Asset Credit Scoring — a patent-pending ten-pillar risk model purpose-built for crypto collateral. AI-powered guidance layer live — members receive plain-language borrowing insights directly from their DACS profile.

03 · Custody

Institutional Custody

Each credit union holds its own direct institutional custody account. Member wallets live within the CU's structure. Aetherum is the software layer only — we never touch member assets.

03 · MARKET OPPORTUNITY

The *largest untapped* lending opportunity in credit union history.

> *"Credit unions are sitting on the largest untapped lending opportunity in their history. Aetherum is the infrastructure layer that makes it accessible."*

TAM · TOTAL ADDRESSABLE MARKET

$150B+

Untapped Crypto Lending Gap

56M Americans hold crypto. Less than 1% can borrow against it through a regulated institution. That's a $150B+ untapped lending gap — with no compliant path to liquidity today.

SAM · SERVICEABLE ADDRESSABLE MARKET

$15–25B

NCUA-Regulated Credit Unions

4,800 NCUA-regulated credit unions. 140M members. An estimated 21M hold crypto today — with no compliant path to liquidity through their trusted financial institution.

SOM · SERVICEABLE OBTAINABLE MARKET

$1.2M → $36M ARR

3-Year Ramp

Year 1: 10 CUs × 100 loans/mo = **$1.2M ARR**
Year 2: 50 CUs × 150 loans/mo = **$9M ARR**
Year 3: 150 CUs × 200 loans/mo = **$36M ARR**

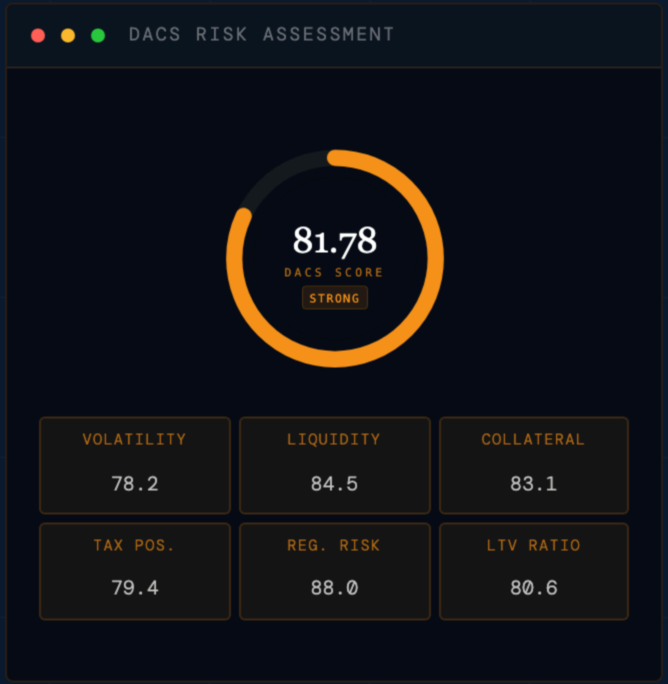
04 · COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

Built for institutions.
No one else is.

	← CONSUMER (D2C)	INSTITUTIONAL (B2B) →
FULL LENDING INFRASTRUCTURE ↑	D2C · FULL LENDING Nexo Ledn SALT Unchained	B2B · FULL LENDING **Aetherum ✦**
↓ CUSTODY ONLY	D2C · CUSTODY —	B2B · CUSTODY ONLY DaLand CUSO

05 · PLATFORM IN ACTION

Most fintech shows you a dashboard.
Aetherum shows you the reasoning.



DACS™ RISK GAUGE

Member sees their risk profile in real time — not just a number.

SMART REVIEW™

Every loan comes with an explanation the member can actually read.

LOAN OFFICER PORTAL

The CU sees everything their examiner wants to see.

06 · TRACTION

Built to the *compliance bar* that keeps others out.

BANK CONNECTIVITY	**Financial data connectivity (CRA bundle) approved and live**— 6 core products active. Production approval used as investor data room leverage.	
COMPLIANCE LAYER	**KYC/AML & fraud integration**— Executed MSA with production-ready compliance infrastructure. Annual billing. Live.	
3 CORE SYSTEMS	Jack Henry FIN contract executed. Banno plugin live in Garden sandbox. Corelation KeyStone integration built and demo-ready. Fiserv AppMarket listing in progress.	
LIQUIDATION LAYER	**Three-tier liquidation escalation — human oversight for every large position** — Tier 1 auto-executes, Tier 2 pages risk officer with 30-min override window, Tier 3 requires explicit loan officer authorization. Twilio SMS + SendGrid alerts, loan officer dashboard actions, full audit trail. Built May 26, 2026.	LIVE
STABLECOIN SETTLEMENT	**Stablecoin Settlement Infrastructure — live in production** — Three-layer settlement stack operational: USDC Collateral Flows, Cross-Chain Transfer Protocol, and Programmable Wallet Infrastructure — live in production.	LIVE
ARC TESTNET	CollateralEscrowTimelock deployed to Arc Testnet (Circle Layer-1, Chain ID: 5042002) — USDC native gas token. Mainnet Q3 2026. 0x1fF9a4c2… 8897	LIVE
CUSTODY	**Enterprise custody — live**— Each CU holds its own direct account — Aetherum never touches assets. Non-custodial by architecture.	
MEMBER CRYPTO INSIGHTS	**New intelligence layer**— Real-time visibility into member-owned digital assets — consent-based, examiner-ready, and patent pending.	

07 · REVENUE MODEL

Five streams. *Platform-fee led.*

Revenue is tied directly to loan volume — meaning we grow as our credit union partners grow. The SaaS license layer adds predictable recurring revenue at scale.

ARR TARGET

$1K/loan × 100 loans/mo × 10 CUs = $1.2M ARR

Tax Intelligence add-on layer creates additional recurring revenue per CU partner.

ERC-3643 module licensing creates a

70%

Platform Fees

$500–$1,500 per loan originated. Primary revenue driver tied to volume.

20%

Transaction Fees

0.5–1% on crypto collateral transactions processed through the platform.

10%

SaaS License

$50K–$150K/year for large credit unions. Predictable ARR layer at scale.

New

Tax Intelligence Module

$10K–25K/year per credit union as a premium add-on. Tells members not just what

08 · TEAM & ADVISORS

Built by operators.
Advised by the ecosystem.

John Bailey

FOUNDER & CEO

20+ years in technical recruiting with placements at Google, Spotify, and Goldman Sachs. Previously co-founded Thorium Data (Data Catalog). Building Aetherum full-time since early 2025, managing all product, BD, fundraising, and technical implementation.

Steve Salzer

BOARD ADVISOR · SVP, VELERA

SVP at Velera since 2017. Chairs the Board of Managers at Ongoing Operations LLC. Sits on the NACUSO Regulatory Advocacy Committee and CUNA Payments Subcommittee. JD, University of Chicago Law School.

Rahul Goel

Saiprasad Raut

09 · THE ASK

Closing a *$1M Pre-Seed* Round.

We're in the final stretch of closing our pre-seed round. Proceeds go toward closing the first two credit union pilots, completing platform development, and bringing on a CTO.

Capital deploys us to first 3 credit union pilots — reducing market risk and proving the explanation layer at scale.

ROUND SIZE	$1,000,000
INSTRUMENT	Post-Money SAFE

REQUEST A DEMO

Let's talk.

20 minutes. We'll walk through the platform live and answer any diligence questions.

BOOK A CALL

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